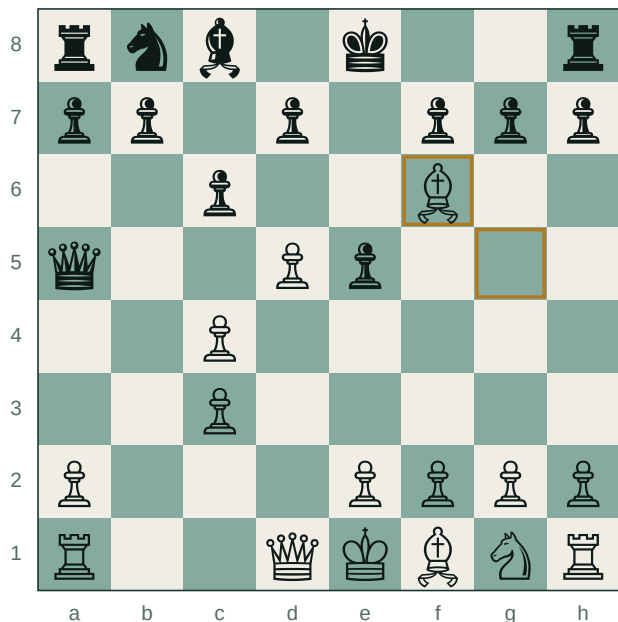


Deflection tactics: Black, move 7

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 7.Bxf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

7...Qxc3+ 8. Qd2 Qxa1+

7...Qxc3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From c3 it attacks king on e1 and rook on a1. Recorded reply: **8.Qd2**.

8...Qxa1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 30 / Black 33 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -3 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e1. Absolute pin: pawn on c3.